

Control structures

Conditional statements and loops

Sequential execution is not enough

- Previously, our code executed instructions line after line, in order
- But sometimes, we need to skip over some instructions, or repeat instructions
- This is where control structures, such as conditional statements and loops come into play

The if statement

- if <test>:
 <statement>
- <test> needs to be an expression that evaluates to true or false
 - If <test> expression is true, then <statement> is executed
 - If <test> expression is false, then <statement> is skipped
- An example in conditionals.py
- What if you want multiple statements to be executed when <test> is true and skipped when <test> is false?

Compound statements

- Almost every programming language has some way to group multiple instructions together to form a compound statement
- Python is one of very few languages that uses indentation to create compound statements
- In python documentation, such compound statements are referred to as a suite
- A suite ends right before the first line that is not as indented as the lines of the suite

Nested if statement example

- myVar=15
if myVar>0:
 print("myVar is positive")
 if myVar>20:
 print("inner statement 1")
 print("Between inner conditions")
 if myVar<20:
 print("inner statement 2")
 print("End of outer condition")
print("After outer condition")

The else statement

- if <test>:
 <statement1>
else:
 <statement2>
- If <test> is true, then <statement1> is executed and <statement2> is skipped
- If <test> is false, then <statement1> is skipped and <statement2> is executed
- Edit conditionals.py to use an else statement instead of two ifs
- Does that change the behavior of what was the two ifs?

The elif statement

- if <test1>:
 <statement1>
elif <test2>:
 <statement2>
elif <test3>:
 <statement3>
else:
 <final statement>
- If <test1> is true, execute <statement1> only
- If <test1> is false and <test2> is true, execute <statement2> only
- If <test1> and <test2> are false and <test3> is true, execute <statement3> only
- If all tests are false, execute <final statement> only (else and <final statement> are optional)

Comparison operators

- == equal
- != not equal
- > greater than
- < less than
- >= greater than or equal to
- <= less than or equal to

Loops

- Sometimes we don't want to selectively skip over instructions, but instead want to repeat instructions
- while <test>:
 <statement>
- Like an if statement, if <test> is false skip <statement>, and if <test> is true execute <statement>.
- But after executing <statement>, check <test> again and if still true, execute <statement> again and check again
- Watch out for infinite loops!